

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Let's look at this matter closely!



Learning Outcome

Analyze issues relating to different topics and their solution in written and spoken situations according to work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can express what is necessary and not necessary.
- I can deal with a communication breakdown.
- I can talk about jobs and work.

Ask your partner:

- Have you heard of the word 'ergonomics'? What does it mean?
- What are some ways you can make your working environment better?





Let's Explore!

Is Adam **discouraged*** after his chat with Denise?

* "Discouraged" means no longer having the confidence you need to continue doing something.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Adam:** Hi Ms. Moore, you wanted to see me?
- Denise:** Yes, Adam. Please, have a seat.
It's been brought to my attention that you are disturbing the work of others.
- Adam:** I'm not quite sure I know what you're getting at, Ms. Moore.
- Denise:** Many of your co-workers have voiced their concerns about your behavior lately. While I appreciate all you've done for the office, making it more ergonomically friendly, you mustn't be taking up the time of others.
- Adam:** Could you elaborate on that please? I don't think I've wasted anyone's time.
- Denise:** In fact, I even came up with cost-effective methods.
- Adam:** That's not what I was saying, Adam. Before we continue, we need to come to a mutual understanding. I need not be questioned about my decision.
- Adam:** Yes, I agree. Also, have you had a chance to read the action plan I put together?
- Denise:** Not yet, Adam. What I'm saying is: you needn't spend too much time on these reports of yours. You must ensure that you're completing the tasks at hand. Once they're completed, then you can spend more time on this. Are you following what I'm saying?
- Adam:** Yes, I understand. I'm sorry, Ms. Moore. I had no idea it was this big of a deal.
- Denise:** Adam, what you're doing ... what you've done is fantastic. You've taken it upon yourself to improve the office's environment and ergonomics. You mustn't be discouraged by this chat. I think you need to continue with this.
- Adam:** So, what you're saying is I must not let it interfere with my job?
- Denise:** Exactly.
- Adam:** Thanks, Ms. Moore.
- Denise:** Have a good day, Adam.



Let's Practice!

What mustn't Adam do?

Instructions: Read the dialogue. Underline the sentences that express what is necessary and circle the sentences that express what is not necessary.

Denise: Adam, it has been brought to my attention that you are disturbing the work of others.

Adam: I'm not quite sure I know what you're getting at, Ms. Moore.

Denise: Many of your co-workers have voiced their concerns about your behavior lately. While I appreciate that you are trying to make our office more ergonomically friendly, you mustn't be taking away time from your co-workers. Before we continue, we need to come to a mutual understanding. I need not be questioned about my decision.

Adam: Yes, I agree.

Denise: What I'm trying to say is that you needn't spend too much time with these reports of yours. You must ensure that you are completing the tasks you are assigned. You mustn't be discouraged by this chat. I think you need to continue with this.

Adam: So, what you're saying is that I must not let this interfere with my job?

Denise: Exactly.



Let's Practice!

What words does Denise use?

Instructions: Find the words in the word search below.

Words

1. ergonomically friendly
2. cost - effective
3. mutual understanding
4. action plan
5. environment
6. ergonomics





Extension Activity

Come up with an ergonomic action plan.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Look around your classroom or workplace. Write down 7-10 ways you think your classroom or workplace can be made more ergonomically friendly.
- Choose 2-3 of the things you wrote down. Come up with an action plan to put your suggestions into motion. Remember to include what is necessary and not necessary.
- Proofread your action plan.
- Read it aloud to your class.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I can identify ways to make a room ergonomically friendly.

☐ ☐

I can express what is necessary and not necessary.

☐ ☐

I write an action plan.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **ergonomically friendly** (expression): designed in a way that makes it comfortable and effective for people who use it for their work
e.g. We are trying to make the office more ergonomically friendly.
- **cost-effective** (adjective): good value for the amount of money paid
e.g. I even came up with cost effective methods.
- **mutual understanding** (expression): a informal agreement between two or more people
e.g. Before we continue, we need to come to a mutual understanding.
- **action plan** (noun): a sequence of steps that must be taken, for a strategy to succeed.
e.g. Also, have you had a chance to read the action plan I put together?
- **environment** (noun): the people and things that are around you in your life
e.g. You've taken it upon yourself to improve the office's environment.
- **ergonomics** (noun): the way in which the careful design of equipment helps people to work better and more quickly
e.g. We ought to improve the ergonomics.





Learning Points

Modals of Necessity and Advice

When you want to talk about things that need to be done or when you want to give advice to coworkers, you can use some particular modal verbs to communicate your ideas.

You use the modals **must**, **need** and their negatives **mustn't** and **needn't** to talk about what is necessary and not necessary.

You use **must** or **need** when something is necessary to be done.

For example: *The article has many mistakes. You **must** check it/ you **need** to check it.*

You use **mustn't** when something is prohibited.

For example:

*You **mustn't** smoke here. We are in a hospital.*

You use **needn't** when there is not necessity of doing something.

For example:

*You **needn't** come to lunch if you don't want to. (You don't have to come to lunch, but if you do is okay)*

The modals **should** or **ought to** can be used to give advice.

For example:

*You **should** do exercise every day. It is good for your health.*

*You **ought to** change the style of chair you have.*

Examples:

- *You **mustn't** be taking away time from your co-workers.*
- *We **need** to come to a mutual understanding.*
- *You **needn't** spend too much time with these reports of yours.*
- *You **mustn't** be discouraged by this chat.*
- *I **need not** be questioned about my decision.*
- *You **ought to** read through the action plan.*





Learning Points

What is an Ergonomic Office Environment?

Ergonomics is the how the design of a workplace affects the productivity of its employees. Improving ergonomics in the office is not difficult, and provides great benefits: An increase in employee comfort and productivity equals a lower risk for work-related injuries.

Here are some tips on how to make your workplace more ergonomically-focused:

- Understand what kind of injuries related to ergonomics exist (muscular disorders)
- Identify current and potential issues in the workplace that can cause ergonomic injuries
- Set up your workstation to optimize your equipment and to minimize any potential injuries.
- Select the right kind equipment (chair, desk, lighting etc.)

